

Wakantanka (Many and Great)

Text: Dakota; Joseph R. Renville, 1846; paraphr. Philip Frazier, 1929, alt.

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is written on three staves in treble clef, key of D major (two sharps), and 2/2 time. The melody is simple, using half and quarter notes with rests. Chords Bm and Em are indicated above the staff at various points. The lyrics are in Dakota, English, and Latin, with some words in italics. The first staff has two verses of lyrics. The second staff has two verses of lyrics. The third staff has two verses of lyrics. The score ends with a double bar line.

Bm Em Bm

1 Wa - kan-tan - ka ta - ku ni - ta - wa tan - ka-ya qa o - ta;
2 Wo - eh - da - ku ni - ta - wa kin he mi - na-gi kin qu wo;
1 *Man - y and great, O God, are your works, mak - er of earth and sky.*
2 *Grant un - to us com-mun-ion with you, O star-a - bid - ing One.*

Bm Em Bm

ma - hpi - ya kin e - ya - hna-ke ça, ma - ka kin he du - o - wan - ca;
ma - hpi - ya kin i - wan-kam ya - ti, wi - co - wa - šte yu - ha nan - ka,
Your hands have set the heav-ens with stars; your fin-gers spread the moun-tains and plains
Come un - to us and dwell with us; with you are found the gifts of life.

Bm Em Bm

mni - o-wan - ca šbe - ya wan-ke cin, he - na o - ya - ki - hi.
wi - co - ni kin he ma - ya - qu nun, o - wi-han - ke wa - nin.
Lo, at your word the wa - ters were formed; deep seas o - bey your voice.
Bless us with life that has no end, e - ter-nal life with you.